

Children's Circle Daycare

Parent Handbook



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Welcome

Children's Circle Daycare has been providing the Riverdale community with safe, affordable, and quality childcare for over 50 years.

We are a play-centered environment and believe that children learn best when they can test new ideas and skills, imitate and explore. We strive to create a program that balances child-centered and teacher-initiated activities, and provide opportunities for children to become active, involved learners. We provide a stimulating environment and are committed to offering activities that accommodate and embrace difference.

The Parent Handbook provides an overview of our daycare and policies. We also post several important policies on our website at www.childrencircledaycare.com. Please review this document before your child starts daycare. Should you have any questions or concerns regarding any information you find in this Handbook, please speak with us. Parents and caregivers are welcome to visit the Daycare, observe our activities, engage with the educators, ask questions and join our circle.

Welcome to Children's Circle Daycare!

Michelle Stropole, RECE
Executive Director

Anne McGee and Terri Ryall
Board of Directors, 2025-2026 Co-Chairs

1 Introduction to Children's Circle Daycare

1.1 Philosophy and Program Statement

Philosophy

Children's Circle Daycare believes that children are competent, capable and curious, and have great potential. The goal of Children's Circle is to support positive and responsive interactions among the children, parents and educators. Partnership between families and the Daycare is essential for the optimal growth and development of young children. We welcome ongoing discussions with parents and caregivers about their child's progress – social, emotional, cognitive – and their daily life at the Daycare.

The Daycare's educators are knowledgeable, empathic, skilled, and caring educators who provide a curriculum based on ongoing observation of the children's play and interactions which correlates into strong child care. We plan for a creative, positive and nurturing environment in which children's play is fostered through exploration, and inquiry. This approach facilitates positive learning and skill development. The educators at Children's Circle has an ongoing commitment to professional growth and learning.

Children's Circle of St. Barnabas Program Statement (updated and revised April 2026)

Our Philosophy

Children's Circle of St. Barnabas believes that children are competent, capable and curious, and have great potential. The goal of Children's Circle is to support positive and responsive interactions among the children, parents and educators. Partnership between families and the centre is essential for the optimal growth and development of young children. We welcome ongoing discussions with parents and caregivers about their child's progress – social, emotional, cognitive, language, physical – and their daily life at Children's Circle.

The educators at Children's Circle of St. Barnabas are knowledgeable, empathic, skilled, and caring educators who provide a curriculum based on ongoing observation of the children's play and interactions which correlates into strong child care. We plan for a creative, positive and nurturing environment in which children's play is fostered through exploration, and inquiry. This approach facilitates positive learning and skill development. The educators at Children's Circle have an ongoing commitment to professional growth and learning.

The Children's Circle of St. Barnabas' Program Statement outlines the strategies used by all its educators to reflect *How Does Learning Happen?* in its daily practice to support the children's growth and development.

1. Promote the health, safety, nutrition and well-being of the children

Children's Circle educators support the health, safety, nutrition and well-being of the children by ensuring the ongoing evaluation of toys and equipment, both inside and outside; supporting healthy food practices for children by aligning our menus with Canada's Food Guide for Healthy Eating; and, providing an environment that is inclusive of all.

Children's Circle educators complete a daily health check of all children entering the program, and ensure that proper hand hygiene is completed upon entering the play spaces; before and after eating and participating in any tactile sensory activity; after using the washroom or wiping a nose; or at any time hands are visibly soiled. All toys and equipment are cleaned and disinfected as required, and all cribs, cots and bedding are cleaned, disinfected or laundered as required.

Children's Circle educators support the nutrition of the children by providing two (2) nutritious snacks and a hot lunch, provided by our onsite cook. The menu changes twice annually (Winter/Fall and Spring/Summer), and the menu is

reviewed by a Certified Dietician on an annual basis. Kitchen staff and educators adhere to all food restrictions and allergies, and are respectful of family beliefs and practices concerning food choices. Educators sit with the children during meal times, promoting a positive attitude towards food and beverages served.

Children's Circle educators are welcoming, and provide an inclusive and safe environment that celebrates the spectrum of diversity, including but not limited to different abilities/disabilities, race, ethnicity, class, culture, linguistic communities, sex, gender identities, sexual orientation and family orientation and family origin, and promotes the physical, mental and emotional well-being of the children. During interactions with children, families and one another, educators are engaged, calm and use an appropriate tone of voice.

Children's Circle supports the ongoing professional development of all its employees in areas of health and safety, including but not limited to, mental health, pedagogy and age-appropriate activities for indoor and outdoor environments. All employees have valid Standard First Aid and CPR-C.

2. Support positive and responsible interactions among the children, parents, childcare providers and staff

At Children's Circle, positive interactions are encouraged and supported by the development of enriched environments where all children belong and where there are a range of interesting, intriguing and developmentally appropriate activity options to engage children. The educators are reflective practitioners whose knowledge and understanding of the individual child and child development supports positive behaviours. The focus on the positive is a key component of our affirming approach.

Children's Circle educators interact with children and parents/guardians during times of arrival and dismissal on a daily basis. The educators use these opportunities to share observations and reflections, and to encourage collaboration between home and child care. We welcome parents/guardians to engage in activities together with their child, to create memories of time shared and to enrich the child and parent/guardian bond.

3. Encourage the children to interact and communicate in a positive way and support their ability to self-regulate

Children's Circle educators encourage positive interactions and communication, and they will model this within the program space throughout the day. Some techniques used are:

- Using a calm tone of voice when speaking with children, parent/guardian, colleagues, student educators, and community partners
- Going over to a child, and getting down to the child's level to speak with them
- Using one's own body language to reflect positive tones and voice level
- Articulating feelings of self and of others
- Asking for assistance, when required

Children's Circle educators spend time getting to know individual children, learning about the child's strengths, abilities and communication style. Recognizing a child's specific triggers and ways of de-escalating, allows the educators to guide and redirect children as they self-regulate in a safe and trusting environment.

4. Foster the children's exploration, play and inquiry

Children's Circle educators will use their observations, knowledge of child development, any individualized plans, and the children's cues to promote continuous learning opportunities. The educators will use external experiences and prior knowledge as a way of enhancing learning experiences.

Children's Circle educators will document their observations in Storypark, and use these observations to inform the activities that are documented on the room program plan, and to plan activity provocations. All observations are shared with the parent/guardian through Storypark.

Children learn through play, and Children's Circle educators will use open-ended questions, flexible programming and

opportunities to introduce new materials, as a way to help children feel that exploration, play and inquiry are a natural way of learning about themselves and the world around them. The emphasis is on process-driven curriculum, and giving children the time they need to explore and inquire during any activity.

5. Provide child-initiated and adult supported experiences

Children's Circle educators will encourage children in the before and after school programs to take the lead on their learning by documenting activities they would like to engage in, onto the program plan themselves.

Children's Circle educators in the infant, toddler and preschool rooms will document observations of children engaged in active learning and exploration in Storypark and share them with families. The educators will connect their observations to the program plan, using the child's initials to indicate whom the activity is based on.

Throughout the rooms, Children's Circle educators will be seen engaging in active learning and exploration with the children, and document their learning by producing homemade books of projects, displaying art work in the room, and writing about it for the monthly newsletter.

6. Plan for and create positive learning environments and experiences in which each child's learning and development will be supported, and which is inclusive of all children, including children with individualized plans

Children's Circle educators are committed to providing learning environments and experiences that are flexible and adaptable as needed by individual children, and are inclusive of all children. Child-initiated activities that allow for process-oriented programming versus product-oriented programming will support children's learning and development as the experiences will be rooted in their personal interests.

Children's Circle educators will enhance each child's learning experience by ensuring age-appropriate furniture, equipment and activities for indoor and outdoor experiences, catering to their individual needs within the group setting. Play spaces will have open shelves that are at a child's level to allow every child to readily access toys and supplies, and they will be in containers that are easily transported throughout the play space.

Children's Circle educators will have time off the program floor to discuss the ongoing needs of the children in the room with their colleagues, and to complete the weekly program plan. The educators will plan adaptations for activities so that all children can be engaged and successful.

Children's Circle will maintain a "Lending Library" of books, puzzles and games that parents may borrow to use at home.

7. Incorporate indoor and outdoor play, as well as active play, rest and quiet time into the day, and give consideration to the individual needs of the children receiving childcare

Children's Circle will ensure that each program's daily schedule includes a balance of indoor and outdoor play, and active play and rest/quiet time, and meets the individual needs of the children in the program.

Children's Circle educators in our Sweet Pea room will follow individual plans, observations and instructions from parents/guardians, and adjust schedules as needed to meet the changing needs of growing children. Sweet Pea children will receive 2 hours of outdoor play daily, and nap times will be based on the needs of the child and any instructions from parents/guardians.

Children's Circle educators in our Toddler, Hunny Bear, Sesame and Dino rooms will plan for a minimum of 2 hours of outdoor play daily, and nap/quiet time will be up to 2 hours. As children in the Hunny Bear, Sesame and Dino rooms prepare for Junior Kindergarten and transition from daily naps, quiet activities will be provided on their bed for an hour and then they will either have quiet activities at a table or have extra outdoor time.

Children's Circle educators in our Cool Cat, Hot Shot and Room Above rooms will plan for 30 minutes of outdoor time

(including the walk back from school) on all instructional days, and for 2 hours of outdoor play on all non-instructional days. The educators will ensure that on non-instructional days there is time for children to engage in quieter activities.

Consideration and/or changes will be made to ensure the child is able to participate at a pace that meets their individual needs, and in collaboration with the child's parents/guardians.

8. Foster ongoing communication with parents about the program and their children

Children's Circle promotes a culture of family involvement, and strong partnerships between the family and educators, to support the children's development and learning.

Children's Circle educators will use a variety of communication tools to ensure parents/guardians are kept apprised of their child's development and growth. Tools used, include but are not limited to, Look See (at age appropriate milestones); daily and/or weekly and/or monthly notes, stories and routines within the Storypark app; at quarterly Open Houses and/or special events at the centre; phone calls; Meet & Greets with families when they start in the centre and when changing rooms; and centre-wide monthly newsletter.

Children's Circle encourages parents/guardians to visit their child's program, volunteer on field trips, volunteer on the Board of Directors, provide feedback and to ask questions regarding their child's progress and activities within the program rooms. Parent/guardian participation in centre-based events enhances the experience of everyone at Children's Circle.

9. Involve the local community partners and allow those partners to support the children, their families, and staff

Children's Circle is committed to providing flexible programming that meets the needs of all children. Our educators collaborate with families, and if necessary, external agencies and/or community partners to provide a program that is adaptable and an environment that promotes the development of children as competent, capable, curious and rich in potential.

Children's Circle educators may engage the services of an external support agency, with parental/guardian consent, to provide them with tools and strategies to modify or adapt the program and/or environment as needed to assist a child to fully participate. Examples of modifications may include:

- Pictorial schedules designed for the child to assist him/her with daily routines
- Pictorial symbols to demonstrate an action, feelings, etc.
- Pre-written instructions for activities and routines
- Self-regulation strategies (can be in the form of pictures, portable toolkit, list of exercises, etc.)
- A wide variety of tools for all skill levels and abilities (large and small balls, broad and thin paintbrushes, printed materials in large font and small font, etc.)
- Materials and equipment are placed at children's level to allow for independent access
- Adjusted table and chair heights
- Adjustments to daily schedules, routines and transitions to encourage optimal learning opportunities for all
- Wider pathways between furniture to allow for use of assistive devices if necessary

10. Support staff or others who interact with the children at a childcare centre in relation to continuous professional learning

Children's Circle is committed to supporting the ongoing professional learning and development of its educators.

Children's Circle educators are required to attend at least two professional learning opportunities per calendar year, and participate in in-house trainings including Standard First Aid and CPR Level C certification. Financial support is available for staff training, and compensated for any time outside of their regular working hours.

Children's Circle educators who are registered and in good standing with the College of Early Childhood Educators (CECE) must adhere to the requirements of the CECE with regards to ongoing professional development.

Children's Circle educators mentor and support Early Childhood Education students from community colleges in Toronto, to develop skills and increase their knowledge in a field placement setting.

11. Document and review the impact of the strategies set out above on the children and their families

Children's Circle views the Program Statement as a living document, and values constructive feedback from all stakeholders regarding our programs, but especially from our children, families and educators.

Children's Circle will engage families in an annual survey to formally gather their feedback on how/if our approaches are meeting the needs of their child and family. Any time families communicate with educators about their child and their child's experiences, it will be documented in the room or office log.

Children's Circle educators review the Program Statement annually to ensure that our current practices are included, and use information gathered formally and informally to explore opportunities for growth and improvements in our approaches.

1.2 Board of Directors

Children's Circle Daycare is a non-profit centre governed by a Board of Directors made up of parents and representatives from St. Barnabas Anglican Church (our facility).

The Board meets on a monthly basis, except during July and August. An Annual General Meeting (AGM) is held each year, at which time we hold elections for the Board of Directors. Parents/caregivers are our membership and are encouraged to attend. Free childcare is provided for in-person AGM's.

Children's Circle has committees from time-to-time, and parental involvement on the committees is encouraged, as it benefits the operations of the Daycare and ensures that we are working together to provide the highest quality care. Please let us know if you are interested in contributing your time.

1.3 Educators

Permanent educators of Children's Circle includes the Executive Director, 30+ full-time educators, and a varying number of part-time educators. Most of our permanent educators have been at Children's Circle for an average of 15+ years. Casual educators include college and summer students, and adults in retraining programs.

In each room, there is a mix of educators, some with their Early Childhood Education certificate (ECE). Educators holding ECE certification register and annually update their membership with the College of Early Childhood Educators, Ontario. Approximately 75% of our educators are Registered Early Childhood Educators. There is a Program Director and an Administrative Assistant who assist the Executive Director in the administration and management of the program at Children's Circle.

All educators, students and volunteers have a Vulnerable Sector Screening from a relevant police service, and all educators have a Standard First Aid and CPR-C certificate, updated as required. All educators, students and volunteers are required to read and sign off on all the policies and procedures of Children's Circle Daycare, including all individual plans for children with anaphylaxis, medical needs and special needs.

1.4 Placement Students and Volunteers

Children's Circle partners with area high-schools and colleges to provide a mutually beneficial learning environment for

students. Placement students are supervised and are introduced to the children and parents/caregivers.

The safety and well-being of the children in our care is of primary importance. Children's Circle Daycare is committed to having policies and procedures in place to be in compliance with the *Child Care and Early Years Act, 2014* regarding volunteers and students.

Children are supervised by a permanent educator over the age of 18. Volunteers and placement students are not counted in meeting prescribed educator to child ratios under the *Child Care and Early Years Act, 2014* and are not left alone with children.

All volunteers and placement students will have Vulnerable Sector Screening from a relevant police service, if they are over 18 years of age. On occasion, we support high school students who are between 16 years old and 18 years old, and are not of age for a Vulnerable Sector Screening. All volunteers and placement students are required to read and sign off on all the policies and procedures of Children's Circle Daycare, including all individual plans for children with anaphylaxis, medical needs and special needs.

1.5 **Waitlist** (see full policy in Appendix 3)

Children's Circle Daycare maintains a waiting list for the childcare programs offered. The waitlist is administered in accordance with the following rules:

1. A child's name will be added to the waitlist in order based on the date Children's Circle received the completed waitlist form. The waitlist will be made available in a manner that maintains the privacy and confidentiality of the children listed. However, we will make information available to the family that is requesting their position on the waitlist.
2. The date of registration on the waitlist will reflect the date the waitlist form is received by Children's Circle.
3. A child's space on the waitlist is not transferable to another family, nor to another child in the same family.
4. When a space becomes available, the Executive Director will offer the family of the child whose name is at the top of the waitlist a space in the childcare program (subject to the priority rules set out below) by telephone or email using the information provided on the registration form. It is the responsibility of the parents to call or email Children's Circle if their contact information changes for any reason.
5. A family that is offered a space at Children's Circle will have up to 2 business days to accept the offer.
6. If the family declines the offer, or fails to respond within 2 days, the space will be offered to the family of the child whose name is next on the waitlist (subject to the priority rules set out below). In such cases, the child's name will stay on the waiting list until the family contacts Children's Circle or until the Executive Director deems the family unreachable/unresponsive.

WAITLIST PRIORITY:

When a space becomes available, families will be offered a space in the centre on the basis of the applicable waitlist, subject to the following priority:

- Siblings of children already attending Children's Circle
- Children who were withdrawn from a program due to maternity/parental leave, and gave advance notice to the Executive Director that they wish to return immediately following the maternity/parental leave
- Children of permanent Children's Circle Daycare educators

As a result of this priority, a child's place on the waitlist is subject to change without notice. For this reason, it is not always possible to accurately predict a child's likelihood of being offered a space in the child care program at a date in the future.

1.6 **Admission** (see full policy in Appendix 3)

Upon your child's admission to Children's Circle, you will receive an enrolment package of information and forms. All forms must be completed and returned before your child's start date. By your child's first day, we require that you submit the completed Preauthorized Debit Agreement, as all monthly daycare fees are withdrawn on the 1st business day of the month for that month. Fees for the first 4 weeks are non-refundable (see 4.7.1 Fees).

Depending on the age and comfort level of your child, children will be transitioned into their age-appropriate room when they enter Children's Circle. Parents and caregivers are encouraged to speak to educators regarding a transition plan that best suits their child's needs.

Where Children's Circle cannot admit a child because we cannot accommodate the child's needs or family circumstances, the Executive Director will:

- a) Document its meetings with the parents/caregivers and the use of any support services with regard to the child.
- b) Notify Toronto Children's Services District Consultant and the Children's Circle Board of Directors.
- c) Refer the parents/caregivers and child to other services, where possible.

1.7 **Withdrawal** (see full policy in Appendix 3)

Children's Circle must receive four weeks' notice in writing if you decide to withdraw your child from Children's Circle. If no notice is given, you will be required to pay full fees for the four weeks.

Children's Circle Daycare will work with families when situations arise whereby a child may need help with behaviour or other concerns, or where communication with parents has begun to break down. Generally, the educators in the room will discuss the behaviour/concerns or communication issues with the child and their parents/caregivers. The Executive Director will be involved depending upon the circumstances. Occasionally, assistance from an outside agency, such as Toronto Children's Services, is recommended and may be used.

In most cases, the behaviour or communication improves or the concerns are addressed. However, from time to time, Children's Circle Daycare may request that a child withdraw from Children's Circle for reasons that include, but are not limited to:

1. The child no longer derives any benefit from the care at Children's Circle Daycare.
2. Communication between parents and Children's Circle is not conducive to the development of the child or is detrimental to the well-being of Children's Circle.
3. The child is putting other children or themselves at risk.

In these cases, Children's Circle will:

- a) Document its meetings with the parents/caregivers and the use of any support services with regard to the child.
- b) Notify Toronto Children's Services District Consultant and the Children's Circle Board of Directors.
- c) Refer the parents/caregivers and child to other services, where possible.
- d) Meet with the family for an exit interview.

The child and family will be given four weeks' notice of the date for withdrawal from Children's Circle, and notice of withdrawal will be given to the family in writing.

2 Family / Caregiver Involvement

2.1 Communication (parent/caregiver)

We take our role in providing care for your children very seriously and value open communication. There are several ways that Children's Circle educators and parents/caregivers can communicate with each other, including the following:

- Drop-off and pick-up times provide limited opportunities for educators and parents/caregivers to exchange information. If a longer conversation is necessary, please schedule a meeting with one of the educators in your child's room.
- We ask that parents/caregivers share any relevant information that will help educators to take better care of your child at the beginning of the day (verbally to a educator, by email to the office or leave a voicemail).
- We encourage parents/caregivers to read information posted in Storypark and on white boards at the end of the day.
- You may choose to leave us a message by the following means:
 - **Email:** info@childrenscircledaycare.com (we check email by 2:00 pm)
 - **Phone:** 416-461-5151 (leave a message with an educator or in the appropriate voicemail box).
- If your child will be absent, please make sure to leave a voicemail message at 416-461-5151 extension "0", and state the reason for the absence. If applicable, please also call your child's school to let them know of the absence.

Concerns and Issues (see full policy in Appendix 4)

We strive to create an atmosphere where parents/caregivers feel comfortable discussing any problem that they might have.

The steps parents are to take:

1. Speak with educators regarding the concern or issue. Educators will respond immediately or within 24 hours if more information is needed. Please note, families are welcome to bring a concern or issue to the Executive Director who may encourage them to speak to the educators. Some concerns or issues may need investigation in order to be resolved. Parents will be updated.
2. Educators will inform the Executive Director of the parent's concern or issue.
3. If parents need clarification of the resolution or are unsatisfied with the resolution, the parents should speak with the Executive Director.
4. Any concern or issue about quality of care should be brought to the Executive Director.
5. If a parent would like to discuss a situation with the Board of Directors of Children's Circle, the Executive Director will contact the Board member responsible for the issue.

All concerns and issues are taken seriously, and will be addressed and attempts will be made to find a mutually satisfactory resolution.

Newsletters and Quarterly Family Events

Please ensure we have your email address, as we produce a monthly newsletter that updates you on the happenings in your child's room. The office sends out emails regularly with updates and reminders, to ensure families are up-to-date

on what is going on.

Children's Circle holds an event for families each quarter. These events may include, but are not limited to, an open house, workshop for parents or an event day in individual rooms. The details of all family event days will be communicated in advance by the office.

2.2 **Parental Separation & Custody Agreements**

All parents or guardians will be required to sign all registration materials. Subsequently, even in the event of a separation of the parents, Children's Circle will continue to accept either parent's authority until provided with written directions signed by both parents, or a court order. If there is a custody agreement, Children's Circle requires a full copy. We will confirm our understanding of the custody agreement with the custodial parent. Without a custody agreement stipulating limited parental access, we cannot deny any parent access to their child(ren).

2.3 **Clothing (and other items requested from home)**

Children should be dressed in appropriate clothing for the season as our program offers both indoor and outdoor play. Children must have safe closures on their clothes such as Velcro, buttons or zippers, and NO strings or dangling straps.

In the summer, children must have footwear that totally encloses the foot (no open-toed sandals or strapless sandals) and should be sent to daycare with a sun hat and sun screen. It is also a good idea to provide a water bottle, clearly labelled with your child's name (we recommend taking it home daily or weekly for a good cleaning).

Clothing should be clearly labeled for identification. We ask that every child have at least one change of clothes, including underwear and socks, that is kept in their cubby. Younger children may need more than one set of extra clothes, as well as a blanket or other comfort item to be used at nap time.

To ensure that personal toys and accessories are not lost or damaged, we ask that items from home are not brought to the daycare unless asked for by the educators (ie: Show and Tell Day).

3 **Programs**

3.1 **Rooms and Schedules**

Children are grouped in designated rooms according to their ages:

Room Name	Number of Children	Approx. Age of Children	Ratio (educators to child)
Sweet Pea	10	6 weeks to 18 months	3:10
Toddler	15	18 to 30 months	1:5
Hunny Bear	16	2 ½ to 4 years	1:8
Sesame Street	24	2 ½ to 4 years	1:8
Dino	16	2 ½ to 4 years	1:8
Cool Cat	26	4 to 6 years	1:13

Hot Shot	30	6 to 12 years	1:15
Room Above (The Roomies)	30	6 to 12 years	1:15

3.2 **Graduating Between Rooms**

The Executive Director is responsible for deciding the children's groups. Children move up depending on the availability of space in the next age group, but it is not always possible if the room(s) is full. From time to time, the Executive Director may decide to move up a child who is a little bit younger because they feel that the child is ready for the next age group. In this case, the Executive Director will consult with the educators and or the parents to ensure that the needs of the child are being met while in our program. Children benefit from different situations in order to further develop their social skills, and moving up with close friends is not always possible. Please speak to the Executive Director if you have any concerns about this issue.

3.3 **Trips**

Trips are part of Children's Circle programming, especially during the summer. These trips are generally planned a month in advance, and information about the trip is communicated to the parents by the educators in the room. The enrolment package contains a blanket permission form for community trips, but we require a special permission form to be signed by parents/caregivers for trips involving public transportation, a school bus or involves water play offsite).

Trip details (e.g., dates, times, and destinations) will be posted on the bulletin board outside the Office under the group's name. If your child's room has a scheduled trip and your child is late and misses the trip, NO alternative care will be available for your child at Children's Circle. Parents/caregivers who do not wish their child to participate in a trip will be required to arrange alternate care for their child.

3.4 **Birthdays and Celebrations**

At Children's Circle we enjoy celebrating birthdays and other special occasions. Please speak with your child's educators about how we can make your child's day a special one. **We kindly ask that you do not bring in any food for celebrations, as there are a number of children and educators with severe food allergies and sensitivities.**

3.5 **Operating Hours, PA Days, Arrivals and Departures**

Children's Circle is open between the hours of 7:30am and 6:00pm, Monday to Friday. Children's Circle is open for all Toronto District School Board PA days.

It is very important that you make contact with an educator upon your child's arrival so that we can maintain our awareness of your child's whereabouts. Please pass on any information regarding your child's mood and health that will help the educators better care for your child.

Parents/caregivers are advised to arrive at Children's Circle by 5:50 pm, so that they have time to dress their child and gather any belongings to go home, and are able to leave Children's Circle by 6:00 pm.

The closing time of 6:00 PM will be determined solely by the clock in the daycare office.

Parents/guardians must notify Children's Circle educators by phone of any potential late pick-ups and their estimated time of arrival.

Late pick-up fees shall apply regardless of the following:

- The number of children being picked up;
- Whether or not advance notice of the late pick-up was provided to centre educators; and
- The parent's reason for being late (please note there are few exceptions in this case).

Late Pick Up Fees (non-base fee):

6:00 PM – 6:20 PM: \$20.00 flat rate

After 6:20 PM penalty fee will be \$5 for each additional 5 minutes that parents are late.

Late Fee Payment: All late fees assessed by the educators to the parent/guardian will be collected by the Executive Director, in cash, as it is given to the educators who remained with the child(ren).

Notwithstanding the above, exceptions to this policy may be made for extenuating circumstances. If your child has not been picked up by 6:00 pm, the educators will try to contact you to inquire about your estimated arrival time. If they are unable to contact you by 6:30 pm, they will call your emergency contact(s) to ask if they can pick up your child. If we have not had any contact with you or your emergency contact(s), the Children's Aid Society will be contacted, which may result in the child being taken into care by the appropriate agency.

If a parent/caregiver is late more than once a month, the situation will be discussed with the Executive Director and escalated according to the provisions in the *Late Pick-Up Policy & Procedure*. If lateness is an ongoing issue, the family's care may be terminated.

4 Policies and Procedures

Children's Circle is committed to providing a safe, affordable quality daycare program. Children's Circle complies with the *Child Care and Early Years Act, 2014*, the *Child and Family Services Act*, the policies and regulations of the Ministry of Education, Toronto Children's Services and Toronto Public Health.

Children's Circle is inspected on an on-going basis and reports are posted. The safety and well-being of the children in the care of Children's Circle Daycare is of primary importance.

This Handbook highlights important policies and procedures. Children's Circle's policies and procedures are designed to make educators, parents and children aware of their roles, responsibilities and rights. A current copy of all policies and procedures are available in the office if you would like to peruse them.

4.1 Anti-discrimination

Children's Circle Daycare values and respects the diverse racial and ethno-cultural background of the community, educators, Board of Directors, volunteers and program users. Children's Circle Daycare does not tolerate discrimination or harassment of any kind on a systemic or personal level.

Educators are required to read and sign the Discrimination and Harassment Policy and procedures, which are regularly reviewed by the Board. In the event of a complaint or incident, the policy and procedures will be explicitly followed to achieve resolution.

4.2 Inclusion

Children's Circle Daycare strives to be inclusive and respectful and will work in partnership with families to ensure that children with varying needs and abilities be included. This is a collaborative process between Children's Circle, the child, and their parents/caregivers that includes assessing the child's needs in relation to what Children's Circle is able to provide.

4.3 Privacy / Confidentiality

Children's Circle has adopted a *Privacy Policy* to govern how personal information is handled at the Daycare.

When seeking to use a child's image (i.e., photo or video) for public materials (website, flyers, other promotional materials), Daycare educators will seek the parents/caregivers' consent by asking a parent/caregiver to sign the Daycare's Consent Form for Photographs and Videos. All consent forms are kept on file at the Daycare Office and will be placed in the child's file.

4.4 **Attendance Policies**

Absence

Please call 416-461-5151 extension "0" or email info@childrenscircledaycare.com if your child is absent, stating the reason for the absence. If applicable, please also call your child's school to let them know of the absence.

December Holiday

Children's Circle will be open until 2pm on December 24th and December 31st, except when December 24th falls on a Monday, then Children's Circle will be closed for the full day. The final decision regarding holiday closures for Children's Circle will be made by the Board of Directors.

Grade 5 Accommodation Policy

Priority for space at Children's Circle is given to children who are Grade 4 and under. In the event that a Grade 5 child wishes to remain at Children's Circle, they may do so only if there is additional space (that is not required for a younger child), at the discretion of the Executive Director.

If there are more Grade 5 children who wish to remain at Children's Circle then there are available spaces, accommodation will be based on the following and in no particular order:

- Seniority at Children's Circle
- Birthdate of child (priority given to children whose birthdays fall later in the year); and,
- Enrollment of siblings at Children's Circle

Vacation

Children's Circle is in full operation twelve months of the year. If your child is to be absent or on vacation, childcare fees are still payable.

Vacation/Absences for Children Receiving Subsidy

All families that receive daycare subsidized by Toronto Children's Services are allowed 35 days of absence per year (or 18 days if your child starts after July 1st) and no more than 20 consecutive days of absence are permitted.

Parents/caregivers are required to pay the subsidized daily rate on days their child is absent.

Parents/caregivers will be invoiced at the full daily rate if their child has been absent for over 35 days, or over 20 consecutive days, unless otherwise approved by Toronto Children's Services.

4.5 **Health Policies**

Behaviour Management

Our goal at Children's Circle is to help children learn to deal with their emotions and actions by communicating and reasoning. As children grow and learn, they go through stages of developing self-control over anger and aggression, depending on maturity, temperament and circumstances. The children learn to take responsibility for their actions and to respect other children and educators.

Children's Circle educators are expected to help children regain control of their emotions and temper, not to stop them from expressing their feelings or moods. All situations are handled in a constructive way helping the child to make choices.

Children's Circle has a *Code of Behaviour* that all children are expected to operate within and a *Behaviour Management Policy* that outlines the expectations for educators when dealing with children exhibiting difficult behaviour. If there is an ongoing problem with aggression and behaviour management, we will work together to resolve the situation, helping children and families through these stages.

We will work with the aggressive child, as well as with other children involved, in order to empower all the children in prevention, planning the situation and in choosing less aggressive behaviour. This is done in a calm, caring and supportive way that emphasizes the safety of children and educators. At times we may refer to other agencies for advice.

If the parents/caregivers are not willing to work with Children's Circle, or the aggressive child is putting himself/herself or others at risk, the child may be withdrawn from Children's Circle.

Toronto Children's Services does not approve the use of any restraint in childcare as a method of intervention for children with challenging behaviours. Physical restraint can only be used in situations where a child is in imminent danger of hurting themselves, another child or educators (e.g., running away from Children's Circle).

If restraint is used, an Incident Report must be completed and kept on file, and a copy given to the parents/caregivers. A follow-up meeting with the Executive Director, educators and parents/caregivers will take place to develop strategies that will be used should the child encounter a similar situation. Parents/caregivers are required to sign off on both the Incident Report and the strategies.

Breastfeeding

The *Ontario Human Rights Commission* has stated that mothers have the right to breastfeed a child in public, and no one should prevent a mother from breastfeeding simply because a mother is in a public area.

Children's Circle Daycare recognizes that breast milk is important for the healthy growth and development of infants and children. We are committed to providing ongoing support to breastfeeding mothers. All mothers are welcome to breastfeed their infants and children at Children's Circle.

Parents who wish to supply breast milk for their child may store the expressed milk in the refrigerator located in the Sweet Pea (infant) room. Each bottle or bag of breast milk must be labelled with the child's name and date. Please see the full *Breastfeeding/ Breast Milk Storage Policy* for further details.

Food and Nutrition/Special Diets

We endeavor to provide balanced, appealing and nutritious meals and snacks for your child using minimally processed foods, and fresh, local or seasonally available foods whenever possible, within our budget and kitchen staff limits. The menus are designed to provide half of your child's daily nutritional needs, follow a four-week rotation and are seasonally adjusted.

Food choice is varied, with some vegetarian and other interesting dishes. Special cultural and ethnic foods may be offered during holidays or with programming events. The menus are reviewed by a dietician whenever any changes are made or every two years.

No outside food is allowed onto our premises without permission from the Executive Director. Compliance with this rule helps to ensure the safety of all children and educators at Children's Circle Daycare, and especially those with severe anaphylaxis food allergies.

If your child requires a special diet because of health or religious reasons, please put the diet in writing and give a copy to the Executive Director or office staff. If we cannot accommodate your child's needs on-site, together, you and the Executive Director can find a mutually satisfactory resolution. If you need to provide food for a special diet, please consult with the Executive Director before bringing in food to Children's Circle.

Rules for Parents Who Send Food with their Child

If parents are providing food from home for their child, regardless of age, room or reason, all food must be labelled with the child's full name and the date the food arrived at the Daycare (if applicable). Parents must include the complete ingredient list if the food is not in the original container which has an ingredient list.

Due to anaphylaxis allergies, all foods must be free from nuts and nut products (including oils and milk) and free from fish, shellfish and products containing these allergens. If you are unsure, please speak with the Executive Director or another staff in the office.

Immunization Records & Emergency Contact

Children are expected to follow the recommended schedule of childhood vaccinations set out by the Canadian Pediatric Society. Children's Circle requires an up-to-date copy of your child's Record of Immunization information upon admission and when your child receives new vaccinations. If there is an outbreak of a particular disease, those children who have not been vaccinated against the disease may be asked to stay home for the duration of the outbreak.

Upon admission, each child's file must contain two emergency contacts, as well as any people to whom your child may be released without notice.

Infection Control

Children can spread germs without being ill themselves. A child with an illness is often infectious before symptoms develop, and sometimes after recovery. A person acting as a carrier may spread germs without having any signs of illness at all. For these reasons, our underlying strategy for infection control is the use of Universal Precautions. The procedures for preventing the spread of infections are outlined in the *Health Policy and Procedures*. Children are encouraged to learn and practice good hand hygiene and other techniques to prevent the spread of infection.

Medication Administration

Children's Circle can administer PRESCRIBED medication. If a child requires prescribed medication during their time at Children's Circle, the parent/caregiver must complete a *Medication Authorization Form* and submit it and the medication to the child's educator. Puffer chambers and the required medication (i. e., Salbutamol, Ventolin) can only remain at the daycare if it is necessary for the medication to be administered on a frequent schedule or for an extended length of time and will need to be accompanied by an individualized health plan. Outdated prescriptions will not be administered to a child.

For any NON-PRESCRIBED medication (e.g., Tylenol), parents/caregivers must have the child's doctor complete a Non-Prescription Medication Administration Form or submit a note from the doctor with the required information (child's name, the medication name, the dosage of medication, instructions for administration and length of time it is to be administered) and provide it and the medication (clearly labelled with the child's name) to the child's teacher. Children's Circle educators may administer non-prescribed cream for the prevention and treatment of diaper rash.

All medication must be in the original container, clearly labelled with the child's name, the medication name, the dosage of medication, instruction for storage, any possible side effects, purchase date and expiry date.

Outdoor Play (and Playground Safety)

Children's Circle is committed to providing a safe and creative outdoor program and to minimize the possibility of injury

by maintaining a safe playground, upgrading toys and equipment and supplying the required supervision. The Children's Circle playground was renovated in 2023 and meets the CSA Standard for children's play spaces and equipment.

The children have access to a variety of stimulating outdoor activities, including unstructured free play, gross motor play and various materials allowing creative outside time which fosters physical, co-operative, social and cognitive development.

While regulations generally require us to take the children outside each day for at least two hours, depending upon the weather and other environmental factors, including extreme cold or heat, the times and location for gross motor play will be adjusted.

Please note that we ask parents/caregivers who pick up prior to 6pm, not to allow their children to play in the playground once they have picked them up in the evening, as it can pose a risk to the health and safety of the children.

Procedures for Illness

A child is considered too ill to attend Children's Circle if their illness prevents the child from participating or being comfortable in normal program activities, or if educators cannot provide the care required.

Parents/caregivers are required to keep their child at home if they are diagnosed with a communicable disease (other than a mild respiratory tract infection) or if they display any of the following symptoms or conditions:

- Cough, if frequent bouts of 3-5 times per hour, especially if choking or vomiting
- Diarrhea, two or more times, or once accompanied by fever or vomiting
- Discharge from the eyes if thick or coloured
- Earache
- Fever higher than 38 degrees, especially if persistent or accompanied by other symptoms
- Lethargy, irritability, drowsiness if accompanied by another symptom
- Persistent pain
- Rash or skin condition, undiagnosed, especially if accompanied by fever or behaviour change
- Vomiting, two or more times, or once accompanied by fever or diarrhea

If a child begins to display symptoms of ill health, their parents/caregivers will be called to pick the child up as soon as possible. If we are unable to contact the parents/caregivers, and the child is seriously ill, we will call their emergency contact(s).

Returning to Daycare

Before an ill child is able to return to Children's Circle, his or her parent/caregiver may be required to provide us with a doctor's note confirming that the child is well enough to participate in the program and is not infectious. Children's Circle Daycare will follow the designated exclusion times as recommended by the Canadian Pediatric Society and Toronto Public Health (see Communicable Diseases & Critters for exclusion times for specific illnesses).

Reportable Diseases

Toronto Public Health has a list of reportable diseases (see Communicable Diseases & Critters) posted in the Children's Circle office. If your child contracts one of these diseases, it is Children's Circle's responsibility to report it to the Medical Officer of Health. In such cases, Toronto Public Health may contact you. Toronto Public Health is notified in the case of an outbreak (when the number of cases exceeds the norm) or when influenza-type cases are spreading.

Communicable Diseases

Children's Circle Daycare follows the guidelines set out by the Canadian Pediatric Society for communicable diseases. Please inform Children's Circle as soon as a diagnosis for any of the following is made for your child:

- Chickenpox
- Conjunctivitis (pinkeye)
- COVID-19
- Croup or Laryngitis
- Ear Infection
- Fever
- Fifth Disease (Parvovirus B19)
- Giardia
- Hand, Foot & Mouth (Coxsackie A16)
- Head Lice
- Hepatitis A
- HIB
- Dehydration and diarrhea
- Impetigo
- Measles
- Meningococcal Disease
- Mumps
- Pinworms
- Ringworm
- Roseola
- Rubella (German Measles)
- Scabies
- Scarlet Fever
- Strep Throat
- Thrush and Candida Diaper Rash
- Whooping Cough (Pertussis)
- Respiratory Syncytial Virus (RSV)

Severe Allergy and Anaphylaxis

If your child has a severe allergy or anaphylaxis, please see Children's Circle's *Anaphylaxis Policy & Procedure*, and discuss the situation with the Executive Director.

Sleep Time

Children's Circle allows for children to have a rest time. Educators monitor children during rest time. The parents of children who rest are notified daily of how long their child slept. The children play hard and need rest midday. Children in the toddler, preschool and kindergarten rooms are permitted to sleep, rest or engage in quiet activities based on the

child's needs. If you have questions or concerns about this, please speak to the educators and we will work together to resolve the issue.

Smoking

Children's Circle is a smoke free facility, and in accordance with the Smoke-Free Ontario Act, 2017, educators, students, volunteers, parents/guardians or any other individual is prohibited from the following activities while on the child care premises, whether or not children are present:

- smoking or holding of lighted tobacco
- smoking or holding of lighted cannabis
- the use of electronic cigarettes
- consuming a prescribed product or substance in a prescribed manner.

Prohibited Practices for Educators

While striving to create an ideal environment for children to thrive, we explicitly prohibit a number of practices that are counterproductive and unacceptable at Children's Circle.

No licensee shall permit, with respect to a child receiving child care at a child care centre it operates or at a premise where it oversees the provision of child care,

- (a) corporal punishment of the child;
- (b) physical restraint of the child, such as confining the child to a high chair, car seat, stroller or other device for the purposes of discipline or in lieu of supervision, unless the physical restraint is for the purpose of preventing a child from hurting himself, herself or someone else, and is used only as a last resort and only until the risk of injury is no longer imminent;
- (c) locking the exits of the child care centre or home child care premises for the purpose of confining the child, or confining the child in an area or room without adult supervision, unless such confinement occurs during an emergency and is required as part of the licensee's emergency management policies and procedures;
- (d) use of harsh or degrading measures or threats or use of derogatory language directed at or used in the presence of a child that would humiliate, shame or frighten the child or undermine his or her self-respect, dignity or self-worth;
- (e) depriving the child of basic needs including food, drink, shelter, sleep, toilet use, clothing or bedding;
- (f) inflicting any bodily harm on children including making children eat or drink against their will. O. Reg. 126/16,

s. 34; or

(g) sexual abuse, sexual misconduct and prescribed sexual acts (as defined under the *Early Childhood Educators Act, 2007*).

4.6 Safety Policies

Children's Circle is committed to providing a safe and creative program and will ensure that measures are in place to control and minimize the possibility of injury. Children's Circle educators shall make every attempt to ensure that the children are playing in a safe environment. No child shall be left without adequate supervision.

Accidents and Accident Reports

All accidents that happen while children are in the care of Children's Circle will be documented by the educators most

closely involved, then reviewed by the Executive Director or designated educator. All accidents will be recorded on an *Accident Report* form. Parents/caregivers are then asked to sign the form, and a copy is given to the parents/caregivers. When warranted, parents/caregivers are informed of the accident by phone.

If the child requires immediate medical attention, the child will be taken to the nearest hospital. The parent will be called to join the child and educators at the hospital. If the child needs medical attention, but it is not a medical emergency, the parents are asked to come to Children's Circle or meet the child and educators at the hospital or clinic. If the accident meets the definition of a Serious Occurrence, it will be reported to the Ministry of Education through the CCLS system.

Child Abuse

Children's Circle Daycare is committed to taking a proactive position regarding the prevention of child abuse. In accordance with the Child and Family Services Act, educators will report any suspected child abuse or any child that might be at risk to the relevant Children's Aid Society.

Emergency/Evacuation

In the event of an emergency at Children's Circle where it is deemed necessary to evacuate the building, our emergency location is Frankland Community School at 816 Logan Avenue. Parents/caregivers will be notified by email and or phone – please see our *Emergency Management and Evacuation Policy & Procedure* for more details.

Extreme Weather-Related Closure

Children's Circle recognizes that, from time to time, there may be circumstances in which significant snowfall, or other adverse weather makes it difficult for Children's Circle to continue normal operations. These difficulties may arise as a result of staffing, logistics and other issues.

It is the policy of Children's Circle to remain open when the schools of the Toronto District School Board are open, and to close when the schools of the Toronto District School Board are closed, to ensure certainty for parents and educators. Families and educators are encouraged to monitor email, X and media outlets for information regarding TDSB closures (typically at or before 6:30am). The Executive Director will notify all families and educators as soon as information is available.

Fire Drills

Fire drills are required by law and conducted monthly. The intent is to ensure children, educators and parents are familiar with the evacuation procedures involved in the event of a fire or other emergency. If the alarm rings everyone must leave the premises. Fire drill procedures are posted in each room.

Pandemic Plan

In the event of a pandemic, the Daycare will follow the directives of the Public Health Agency of Canada, the Ontario Ministry of Health and Long-term Care and Toronto Public Health. This may include screening of children and educators and possible closures. Please refer to the *Pandemic Policy* for further information.

Pick-up Release Authorization

All children must leave the Daycare with a person over 16 years of age. On the admission form you can list the names of people to whom your child can be released. It is your responsibility to keep the Daycare informed of any changes to this information. PLEASE contact us directly or leave a message if plans change during the day. The Daycare will not release a child to a person who is not authorized to pick them up, without prior notification from a parent/caregiver.

Escort to Schools

Daycare educators escort children to three elementary schools: Frankland, Jackman and Withrow. To attend each school you must live in the catchment area for that school. School admission is the responsibility of the Toronto District School Board (TDSB).

The Daycare educators stay with the children until the children enter the school. The TDSB educators are responsible for the daycare children on school property.

Serious Occurrences

Licensed child care centres are required to post information about serious occurrences that happen at the daycare. A Serious Occurrence Notification Form will be posted in the front entrance for 10 days from the date of making. This notice will provide the Daycare community with information, including follow-up actions and outcomes, while respecting the privacy of the individuals involved. Please refer to the *Serious Occurrence Policy* for further information.

Sun Safety

During the summer months, Daycare educators check for any Heat Advisories, Smog Alerts and Humidex Advisories on a daily basis and plan accordingly. The Daycare automatically receives Smog Alerts issued by Air Quality Ontario, and on such days, we reduce time spent outside for the Sweet Pea and Toddler groups, and for older children as necessary.

The time spent outside can be flexible and may change to earlier in the morning or later in the afternoon on days when heat, humidity and smog are factors. The educators monitor the children for heat-related illness (e.g., heat exhaustion, heat stroke), paying special attention to children with asthma. Drinking water is available on the playground at all times.

We kindly ask that parents provide sunscreen for their child, and that it is clearly labeled with the child's name from May 1st to September 30th. If you cannot provide sunscreen for your child, the Daycare will provide sunscreen with an SPF 30 or greater. Sunscreen is applied to each child before going outside on a daily basis, in both the morning and afternoon.

Safe Arrival and Dismissal (see full policy in Appendix 5)

To ensure the safe arrival and dismissal of any child receiving child care at the Daycare, we ask that parents make contact with a staff member in the room before leaving, so that the staff can ensure the child is marked as being in our care or marked as having been picked up.

If a child has not arrived as expected, we will be calling and or emailing families to inquire about the child's whereabouts. If your child(ren) is going to be absent or late for any reason, please email the office at info@childrenscircledaycare.com to let us know. If your child is absent due to illness, please let us know what the symptoms or diagnosis is, so that we can monitor for any outbreaks or requirement for enhanced cleaning and disinfecting.

We will only release to the child's parent/guardian or an individual that the parent/guardian has provided written or verbal authorization to whom the child may be released, provided that the individual is 16 years of age or older.

4.7 Financial Policies

Fees

Daycare fees are subject to change. Parents/caregivers are given one month's notice in advance of any fee changes.

Upon enrolment, we ask that the completed Preauthorized Debit Agreement and VOID cheque be submitted, as we withdraw monthly fees on the 1st business day for the current month. Fees are calculated on a daily basis and not on your child's actual attendance.

Children's Circle does not provide refunds or fee reductions for:

- Families with more than one child enrolled with the Daycare.
- Days that your child is absent.
- Statutory holidays when the Daycare is closed (i.e., New Year's Day, Family Day, Good Friday and Easter Monday, Victoria Day, Canada Day, Civic Holiday, Labour Day, Thanksgiving Day, Christmas Day and Boxing Day).
- Days when daycare is open for part of the day (i.e., Christmas Eve and New Year's Eve).

If your child is withdrawn during the first four weeks of care, the paid fees are non-refundable.

If a family falls behind in paying their fees, the family will be asked to submit a payment schedule to the Executive Director. If the payment schedule is not followed, the Daycare will turn the account over to a collection agency and your child will be withdrawn from the Daycare.

Refunds will only be given in rare circumstances. These might include: when directed by the Ministry of Education or Toronto Children's Services, due to mandated closure of all child care centres; or when a full fee family is approved for fee subsidy through Toronto Children's Services and monthly fees have already been paid.

Receipts are provided for received payments. Year-end receipts (for tax purposes) are provided in February for the total fee payments received for each child in our care for the prior calendar year.

Canada-Wide Early Learning and Child Care (CWELCC) Funding System

Children's Circle Daycare applied for and was accepted in the CWELCC funding system in September 2022. This program is a partnership between the federal and provincial governments to reduce fees for children aged 0 to 6 years. (NOTE: Children in a licensed kindergarten program are eligible until June 30th if their birthday occurs between January and June. Children in a licensed school-age program are eligible until the end of month in which they turn 6 years.)

Families who are receiving fee subsidy will be advised by the subsidy office as to any reduction in their daily fee.

NSF (non-base fee)

Parents/caregivers will have to pay the bank fee for any payments that are NSF.

Base Fees for 2026

	2026 Daily Fee (non-CWELCC)	2022 Fee Freeze Rate	2026 Daily Fee (CWELCC)
Sweet Peas (6 weeks to 18 months)		\$98.35	\$22.00
Toddlers (18 months to 2 ½ years)		\$78.68	\$22.00
Hunny Bear, Sesame, Dino (2 1/1 to 4 years)		\$62.12	\$22.00
Cool Cats (4 to 6 years)			
Instructional Days		\$34.69	\$16.39
Non-Instructional Days		\$53.32	\$22.00
Hot Shots and Room Above (6 to 10 years)			

Instructional Days	\$33.62	\$30.02	\$14.18*
Non-Instructional Days	\$57.65	\$51.76	\$22.00*

* Hot Shot and Room Above: the CWELCC fee is charged for children who are 5 years or younger, and until the last day of the month in which the child turns 6 years old.

Notes:

- 1) Part time spaces may be available in the Toddler, Hunny Bear, Sesame and Dino rooms. There are no part time spaces in the Sweet Pea, Cool Cat, Hot Shot and Room Above rooms.
- 2) Days we are open but the schools are closed: monthly invoices automatically include P.A. Days, December Holiday Break, March Break and the Summer Break.
- 3) We escort children who attend Frankland, Jackman and Withrow schools only.

5 Appendix 1: Communicable Diseases & Critters

The following lists of common communicable diseases and critters are maintained and updated by Toronto Public Health and can be accessed [online](#).

Disease	Signs & Symptoms	Transmission	Infectious Period	Exclude?
Chickenpox (Varicella-Zoster virus)	Generalized, itchy rash: Crops of small red spots turn into fluid-filled blisters that crust as they resolve. Other systemic symptoms such as fever.	Airborne: Spreads easily from person-to-person through the air (coughing/sneezing). Contact: Direct contact with the fluid from the blisters or respiratory secretions.	1 to 2 days before the rash develops, until crusting of all lesions (usually 5 days).	Yes - while <i>TPH</i> does not require exclusion, as an additional precaution <i>CCD</i> will exclude for 5 days after onset of blisters/rash and when scabs are dry.
Norwalk (Norovirus)	Sudden onset of watery diarrhea, abdominal cramps and nausea. Symptoms last from 24 to 60 hours.	Contact: Direct contact with bodily fluids (contaminated hand to mouth). Indirect contact with contaminated food, water or other objects or surfaces contaminated with stool.	For duration of diarrhea.	Yes -24 hrs symptom free Or 48 hrs symptom free during an outbreak.
Measles aka Rubeola, Red Measles (Morbillivirus)	High fever, cough, runny nose, red eyes for 2 to 4 days before rash starts. Rash begins on face as small red spots, which enlarge and clump together and spreads down body.	Airborne: Spread easily from person-to-person through the air (Highly contagious). Contact: Direct contact with respiratory secretions of an infected person..	3 to 5 days before onset of rash until 4 days after onset of rash.	Yes - Until 4 days after beginning of rash and when the child is able to participate.
Mumps (Rubulavirus)	Swollen and tender glands at the jawline on one or both sides of the face. May include fever, malaise, headache, inflamed testes and respiratory symptoms (especially for children aged five and under.)	Droplet: From coughs and sneezes of an infected person to a distance of < 2 metres. Contact: Direct contact with the saliva/respiratory secretions of an infected person.	7 days before to 9 days after onset of swelling.	Yes – while <i>TPH</i> recommends exclusion until 5 days after onset of parotid gland swelling, as an additional precaution <i>CCD</i> will exclude for 9 days.
Pertussis aka Whooping Cough (Bordetella pertussis)	Usually begins with runny nose and cough. Cough progressively becomes frequent and severe and may result in a high-pitch whoop sound. Loss of breath or vomiting after coughing bouts may occur. May last 6 to 10 weeks.	Droplet: From coughs and sneezes of an infected person to a distance of < 2 meters.	Highly infectious in the early stages of runny nose and cough to 3 weeks after onset of whooping cough (paroxysms), if not treated. Or after 5 days of treatment.	Yes - Until 5 days of appropriate antibiotics have been completed. If untreated, until 21 days after onset of cough.
Rubella aka German Measles (Rubivirus)	Characterized by a red rash, low-grade fever and swelling of the glands in the neck and behind the ears. Usually uncomplicated illness in children.	Droplet: From coughs and sneezes of an infected person to a distance of < 2 meters. Contact: Direct contact with respiratory secretions of an infected person.	7 days before to 7 days after onset of rash.	Yes -For 7 days after onset of rash.

Common Cold (Rhinoviruses)	Runny nose, sneezing, sore throat, cough, fever, headache, decrease of appetite and lack of energy. Most colds last for 7 to 10 days.	Droplet: From cough and sneeze of an infected person to a distance of < 2 meters. Contact: Direct contact with respiratory secretions. Indirect contact with toys, other objects or surfaces contaminated with respiratory secretions.	Highest during the first 2 to 3 days of symptoms and until 7 to 10 days after onset of symptoms.	No - If child feels well enough to participate.
Hand, Foot & Mouth Disease (nonpolio enteroviruses)	Fever, loss of appetite, malaise, sore throat, small painful mouth ulcers and a rash (small red spots or blisters on hands, feet and in mouth) and headache. May last 7 to 10 days.	Contact: Direct contact with stool, saliva, nose and throat secretions or fluid from the blisters of an infected person. Indirect contact with contaminated toys, objects or surfaces.	For duration of illness and up to several weeks after onset of illness.	No - If child feels well enough to participate.
Impetigo (Streptococcus pyogenes or Staphylococcus aureus)	Cluster of red bumps or fluid-filled blisters, which may ooze a clear fluid or become covered by an itchy honey-coloured crust. Usually appears around a child's mouth, nose or on exposed skin of the face or limbs.	Contact: Direct contact with skin lesions. Indirect contact with contaminated bed linens or clothing.	From onset of rash until 1 day after start of treatment.	Yes - Until 24 hours after treatment has been initiated. Lesions on exposed skin should be covered.
Fifth Disease aka "Slapped Cheek" erythema infectiosum (Parvovirus B19)	A very red rash on a child's cheeks (slapped face appearance). A red, lace-like rash develops on torso and arms, then over the rest of the body. Rash may itch occasionally. May have low-grade fever, malaise, or a mild cold before rash starts. Rash may last 1 to 3 weeks.	Contact: Direct contact with respiratory secretions.	Several days before the appearance of the rash. Not infectious once rash appears.	No - If child feels well enough to participate.
Conjunctivitis aka Pink Eye Bacterial (non-typable Haemophilus influenzae and S. pneumoniae) Viral (adenoviruses)	Purulent: Pink or red eyeballs, white or yellow discharge, matted or red eyelids and eye pain. Usually caused by a bacterial infection. Non-Purulent: Pink or red eyeball, clear and watery discharge, mild or non pain. May be caused by virus or non-infectious condition.	Contact: Direct contact with eye secretions. Droplet: From coughs and sneezes of an infected person to a distance of < 2 meters.	Bacterial: Infectious until 24 hours of appropriate antibiotic treatment. Viral: Infectious as long as there is eye discharge.	Yes - Until assessed by their health care provider. For bacterial conjunctivitis exclude until 24 hours after appropriate antibiotics has started.
Ringworm (of the body) aka Tinea Corporis (various types of fungi)	Itchy, flaky ring-shaped rash, on face, trunk, limbs, scalp, groin or feet.	Contact: Direct contact (skin-to-skin). Indirect contact sharing combs, unwashed clothes, shower or pool surfaces and under fingernails from scratching. Can also be acquired from pets.	As long as rash is untreated or uncovered.	Yes - Until the appropriate treatment has been started.
Scarlet Fever (Streptococcus)	Sore throat, fever, swollen tender neck glands with widespread	Contact: Direct contact with saliva.	Until 24 hours after appropriate antibiotic	Yes - Until 24 hours after treatment has started

pyogenes)	bright red rash covering the entire body. Commonly seen on neck, chest, underarms, elbow, groin and inner thigh, tongue (strawberry tongue). Typically rash does not involve face, but there may be flushed cheeks. Rash feels like sandpaper.	Droplet: From coughs and sneezes of an infected person to a distance of < 2 meters.	treatment started. In untreated cases, 10 to 21 days.	and the child is able to participate in activities.
Strep Throat (Streptococcus pyogenes)	Sore throat, fever and swollen tender neck glands.	Contact: Direct contact with saliva. Droplet: From coughs and sneezes of an infected person to a distance of < 2 meters.	Until 24 hours after appropriate antibiotic treatment started. In untreated cases, 10 to 21 days.	Yes - Until 24 hours after treatment has started and the child is able to participate in activities.

Critters	Signs & Symptoms	Transmission	Infectious Period	Exclude?
Head Lice aka Pediculosis capitis (Pediculus humanus capitis is the head louse)	Itchy scalp, nits (whitish-grey egg shells) attached to hair shafts, live lice.	Contact: Direct contact head-to-head (live lice). Indirect contact by sharing hats, hair brushes, headphones, etc.	While nits or lice are present.	Yes - while <i>TPH</i> does not require exclusion, as an additional precaution <i>CCD</i> will exclude until nits or lice are absent.
Pinworms aka Enterobius vermicularis (Enterobius vermicularis is a nematode or roundworm)	Itching around the anus, disturbed sleep and irritability.	Contact: Direct contact from fingers contaminated from scratching. Indirect contact from contaminated bed linens, clothing, toys, etc.	Until treatment is completed.	No - Re-infection from contaminated hands is common, therefore reinforce hand washing.
Scabies (Sarcoptes scabiei is a mite)	Red, very itchy rash which usually appears between fingers, on palms, underarms, wrists, soles, elbows, head and neck. Itchiness is usually worse at night.	Contact: Direct contact from person-to-person, prolonged, close and intimate skin-to-skin contact. Mites are almost invisible to the naked eye.	Until treated, usually after 1 or 2 courses of treatment, a week apart.	Yes - Exclude until after 24 hours of the first treatment given.

Appendix 2: Code of Behaviour

Children's Circle Daycare acknowledges that most children and adults behave appropriately in a manner which reflects self-discipline and respect for all. The fostering of such behaviour is integral to Children's Circle's programs. This behaviour is expected, appreciated and recognized.

The following Code defines this acceptable behaviour and outlines the consequences that can be expected when the Code of Behaviour is not followed.

It should be noted that appropriate behaviour is primarily recognized through self-satisfaction and good citizenship.

Policy:

The Code of Behaviour applies to children interacting with each other and with the educators, and requires that individuals exhibit self-discipline and respect for all.

Appropriate behaviour is recognized through verbal recognition. Clear and fair consequences will occur for individual children so that they take responsibility for their behaviour. In responding to behaviour that is counter to the Code, the child's dignity and self-worth is considered and an opportunity is provided for growth and change.

Consequences of breaching the Code of Behaviour can escalate to include expulsion from Children's Circle for children and dismissal for educators.

Roles and Responsibilities:

Children's Circle educators and children have the right to:

- Be part of an environment that is free from abuse. This includes physical or verbal abuse such as racism, hitting, bullying, kicking, biting, swearing, name-calling, throwing furniture or other objects, or any other behaviour that causes harm or damage to themselves, others or Children's Circle property.
- Learn in a clean, safe, positive environment.
- Be treated with respect and courtesy.
- Have their personal best encouraged.

Children's Circle educators and children have a responsibility to:

- Act within the established expectations.
- Respect the property of fellow children, the daycare and the community.
- Respect authority.
- Respect the feelings and abilities of others.
- Obey the Children's Circle Daycare Code of Behaviour.
- Celebrate the accomplishments of others.

Procedure:

Progression of Consequences

Open communication and use of conflict resolution skills among educators, parents and children will usually negate the necessity of severe consequences. In situations meriting more serious consequences, parents are expected to be part of the solution. Since children and circumstances are of an individual nature, any of the following may be considered:

- Discussion and counseling between children and educators
- Verbal warning to children and parents

- Letter to parents requesting their intervention to improve the behaviour
- Privileges removed
- Exclusion from a class, program or event
- Behaviour and/or strategies to repair or replace damaged property
- Formal request for intervention from outside agencies
- Formal request that the child be removed from Children's Circle, which is officially recorded at the daycare and with other relevant agencies

Note that if a child is behaving in an unsafe manner, a parent will be required to pick up the child immediately.

Children's Circle Daycare can use restraint on a child only if that child is an imminent danger to themselves or others.

Appendix 3:

Policy Name	Wait List, Admission and Withdrawal Policy and Procedure		
Approved By: Board of Directors	Last Approval Date: April 20, 2022	Last Review Date: April 20, 2022	Last Revision Date: April 20, 2022

Policy Statement

Children's Circle Daycare (CCD) is committed to ensuring families understand how we handle the wait list, admissions and withdrawals.

Purpose

To provide direction on how Children's Circle Daycare (CCD) handles its waiting list, admissions, and withdrawals in a fair, consistent and transparent manner that also maintains the necessary balance in each room.

Procedures

Wait List Procedure

To gain access to the wait list, families must submit a completed application form available on our website at www.childrengcircledaycare.com or at the Daycare office. A child who is already enrolled in the Daycare in one room does not have to apply to be on the wait list in another room.

Wait List Management:

The Director maintains a waiting list for all of the childcare programs offered by CCD. The waitlist is administered in accordance with the following rules:

1. A child's name will be added to the waitlist in order based on the date the Daycare received the completed registration form. The waitlists will be made available in a manner that maintains the privacy and confidentiality of the children listed. However, we will allow information available to the family that is requesting their position on the waitlists.
2. The date of registration on the waitlist will reflect the date the registration form is received by the Daycare.
3. A child's space on the waitlist is not transferable to another family.
4. When a space becomes available, the Director will offer the family of the child whose name is at the top of the waitlist a space in the childcare program (subject to the priority rules set out below) by telephone or email using the information provided on the registration form. It is the responsibility of the parents to call or email CCD if their contact information changes for any reason.
5. A family that is offered a space in the Daycare will have up to 2 days to accept the offer.
6. If the family declines the offer, or fails to respond within 2 days, the space will be offered to the family of the child whose name is next on the waitlist (subject to the priority rules set out below). In such cases, the child's name will stay on the waiting list until the family contacts CCD or until the Director deems the family unreachable/unresponsive.

Wait List Priority:

When a space becomes available, families will be offered a space in the centre on the basis of placement on the wait list, subject to the following priority:

- Siblings of children already attending CCD
- Children who were withdrawn from a program due to maternity/parental leave, and gave advance notice to the Director that they wish to return immediately following the maternity/parental leave
- Children of permanent Children's Circle Daycare staff

As a result of this priority, a child's place on the waitlist is subject to change without notice. For this reason, it is not always possible to accurately predict a child's likelihood of being offered a space in the childcare program at a date in the future.

Admission Procedure

Prior to enrollment, the parents of a child who has been admitted to Children's Circle Daycare will be provided with an enrolment package, which will include the following:

- A copy of Children's Circle Daycare *Parent Handbook* outlining the general policies and practices of the Daycare.
- A registration package which parents/guardians must complete and return as a condition of enrollment.

In addition, parents of all children admitted to the Daycare are required to provide an up-to-date immunization record obtained from the child's family doctor.

Where the Daycare cannot admit a child because the Daycare cannot accommodate the child's needs or family circumstances, the Daycare will:

- Document meetings with the parents/caregivers and the use of any support services with regard to the child.
- In some cases, further steps could include:
 - i. Notifying Toronto Children's Services and the Daycare Board of Directors
 - ii. Referring the parents/caregivers and child to other services, where possible.

Withdrawal Procedure

Withdrawal

The Daycare must receive four weeks' notice in writing of the parents' intention to withdraw their child(ren) from the Daycare. If no notice is given, parents will be required to pay full fees for the four weeks. This procedure is followed for all families.

Withdrawal at the request of the Daycare/Denial of Admission

Children's Circle Daycare will work with families when situations arise whereby a child may need help with a behaviour or other concerns, or where communication with parents has begun to break down. Generally, the staff in the room will discuss the behaviour/concerns with the child and their parents. The Director will be involved depending upon the circumstances. Also, occasionally assistance from an outside agency, such as Toronto Children's Services, is recommended and may be used. In most cases, the behaviour or communication improves or the concerns are

addressed. However, from time to time, the Daycare might request a child to withdraw from the Daycare for reasons that may include, but are not limited to:

1. The child no longer derives any benefit from the care at Children's Circle Daycare.
2. Communication between parents and the Daycare is not conducive to the development of the child or is detrimental to the well-being of the Daycare.
3. The child is putting other children or themselves at risk.

In these cases, the Daycare will:

- (i) document its meetings with the parents and the use of any support services with regard to the child,
- (ii) notify the Children's Services Consultant,
- (iii) notify the Board of the Daycare,
- (iv) refer the parents and child to other services, where possible, and
- (v) meet with the family for an exit interview.

The child and family will be given four weeks' notice in writing of the date for withdrawal from the Daycare. The procedure set out above is followed for all families with children who are asked to leave.

Where the Daycare cannot admit a child because the Daycare cannot accommodate the child's needs or family circumstances, the Daycare will:

- (i) document its meetings with the parents and the use of any support services with regard to the child,
- (ii) notify the Children's Services Consultant,
- (iii) notify the Board of the Daycare, and
- (iv) refer the parents and child to other services, where possible.

The procedure set out above is followed for all families with children who have been denied admission.

Policy and Procedure Review

This policy and procedure will be reviewed and signed off by all employees, students and volunteers prior to commencing employment/unpaid placement at CCD and annually thereafter, and at any time where a change is made.

Appendix 4

Policy Name	Parent Issues and Concerns Policy and Procedure		
Approved By: Board of Directors	Last Approval Date: November 16, 2022	Last Review Date: November 14, 2022	Last Revision Date: November 14, 2022

Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to provide a transparent process for parents/guardians, the child care licensee and staff to use when parents/guardians bring forward issues/concerns.

Applies to

This policy applies to all employees, parents/guardians, students, and any other persons engaged in business with CCD.

Policy Statement

Parents/guardians are encouraged to take an active role in Children's Circle Daycare and regularly discuss what their child(ren) are experiencing within our program. As supported by our program statement, we support positive and responsive interactions among the children, parents/guardians, child care staff, and foster the engagement of and ongoing communication with parents/guardians about the program and their children. Our staff are available to engage parents/guardians in conversations and support a positive experience during every interaction.

All issues and concerns raised by parents/guardians are taken seriously by Children's Circle Daycare and will be addressed. Every effort will be made to address and resolve issues and concerns to the satisfaction of all parties and as quickly as possible.

Issues/concerns may be brought forward verbally or in writing. Responses and outcomes will be provided verbally, or in writing upon request. The level of detail provided to the parent/guardian will respect and maintain the confidentiality of all parties involved.

An initial response to an issue or concern will be provided to parents/guardians within 24 hours, unless additional information is required, in which case staff will endeavor to provide a response within 5 business day(s). The person who raised the issue/concern will be kept informed throughout the resolution process.

Investigations of issues and concerns will be fair, impartial and respectful to parties involved.

Confidentiality

Every issue and concern will be treated confidentially and every effort will be made to protect the privacy of parents/guardians, children, staff, students and volunteers, except when information must be disclosed for legal reasons (e.g. to the Ministry of Education, College of Early Childhood Educators, law enforcement authorities or a Children's Aid Society).

Conduct

Children's Circle Daycare maintains high standards for positive interaction, communication and role-modeling for children. Harassment and discrimination will therefore not be tolerated from any party.

If at any point a parent/guardian or staff feels uncomfortable, threatened, abused or belittled, they may

immediately end the conversation and report the situation to the Director.

Concerns about the Suspected Abuse or Neglect of a child

Everyone, including members of the public and professionals who work closely with children, is required by law to report suspected cases of child abuse or neglect.

If a parent/guardian expresses concerns that a child is being abused or neglected, the parent will be advised to contact the [local Children's Aid Society](#) (CAS) directly.

Persons who become aware of such concerns are also responsible for reporting this information to CAS as per the "Duty to Report" requirement under the *Child and Family Services Act*.

For more information, visit

<http://www.children.gov.on.ca/htdocs/English/childrensaidthereportingabuse/index.aspx>

Procedures

Nature of Issue or Concern	Steps for Parent and/or Guardian to Report Issue/Concern:	Steps for Staff, Director and/or Licensee in responding to issue/concern:
Program Room-Related E.g: schedule, sleep arrangements, toilet training, indoor/outdoor program activities, feeding arrangements, etc.	Raise the issue or concern to - the classroom staff directly or - the Director.	- Address the issue/concern at the time it is raised or - arrange for a meeting with the parent/guardian within 5 business days. Document the issues/concerns in detail. Documentation should include: - the date and time the issue/concern was received; - the name of the person who received the issue/concern; - the name of the person reporting the issue/concern; - the details of the issue/concern; and - any steps taken to resolve the issue/concern and/or information given to the parent/guardian regarding next steps or referral. Provide contact information for the appropriate person if the person being notified is unable to address the matter.
General, Centre- or Operations-Related E.g: child care fees, hours of operation, staffing, waiting lists, menus, etc.	Raise the issue or concern to - the Director.	Ensure the investigation of the issue/concern is initiated by the appropriate party within 5 business days or as soon as reasonably possible thereafter. Document reasons for delays in writing.
Staff, Director, and/or Licensee-Related	Raise the issue or concern to - the individual directly or - the Director or - the Board of Directors (when the issue or concern is in regards to the conduct of the Director). All issues or concerns about the	Provide a resolution or outcome to the parent(s)/guardian(s) who raised the

Nature of Issue or Concern	Steps for Parent and/or Guardian to Report Issue/Concern:	Steps for Staff, Director and/or Licensee in responding to issue/concern:
	conduct of staff, that puts a child's health, safety and well-being at risk should be reported to the Director as soon as parents/guardians become aware of the situation.	issue/concern.
Student- / Volunteer-Related	Raise the issue or concern to - the staff responsible for supervising the volunteer or student or - the Director. All issues or concerns about the conduct of students and/or volunteers that puts a child's health, safety and well-being at risk should be reported to the Director as soon as parents/guardians become aware of the situation.	

Escalation of Issues or Concerns: Where parents/guardians are not satisfied with the response or outcome of an issue or concern, they may escalate the issue or concern verbally or in writing to the Director or the Board of Directors (where appropriate).

Issues/concerns related to compliance with requirements set out in the *Child Care and Early Years Act, 2014* and Ontario Regulation 137/15 should be reported to the Ministry of Education's Child Care Quality Assurance and Licensing Branch.

Issues/concerns may also be reported to other relevant regulatory bodies (e.g. local public health department, police department, Ministry of Environment, Ministry of Labour, fire department, College of Early Childhood Educators, Ontario College of Teachers, College of Social Workers etc.) where appropriate.

Policy and Procedure Review

This policy and procedure will be reviewed and signed off by all employees, volunteers and students prior to commencing employment/unpaid placement at CCD and annually thereafter and at any time where a change is made.

Appendix 5

Policy Name	Safe Arrival and Dismissal Policy and Procedure		
Approved By: Board of Directors	Last Approval Date: September 10, 2025	Last Review Date: September 8, 2025	Last Revision Date: September 8, 2025

Purpose

This policy and the procedures within help support the safe arrival and dismissal of children receiving care at Children's Circle Daycare.

This policy will provide staff, placement students and volunteers with a clear understanding of their roles and responsibilities for ensuring the safe arrival and dismissal of children receiving care, including what steps are to be taken when a child does not arrive at the child care centre as expected, as well as steps to follow to ensure the safe dismissal of children.

This policy is intended to fulfill the obligations set out under Ontario Regulation 137/15 for policies and procedures regarding the safe arrival and dismissal of children in care.

Policy

Children's Circle Daycare will ensure that any child receiving child care at the child care centre is only released to the child's parent/guardian or an individual that the parent/guardian has provided written or verbal authorization to whom the child may be released to.

Children's Circle Daycare will only dismiss children into the care of their parent/guardian or another authorized individual who is 16 years of age or older. Children's Circle Daycare will not release any children from care without supervision.

Where a child does not arrive in care as expected or is not picked up as expected, staff must follow the safe arrival and dismissal procedures set out below.

Procedure

Accepting a child into care

When accepting a child into care at the time of drop-off, program staff in the room must:

- greet the parent/guardian and child
- ask the parent/guardian how the child's evening/morning has been and if there are any changes to the child's pick-up procedure (i.e., someone other than the parent/guardian picking up). Where the parent/guardian has indicated that someone other than the child's parent/guardians will be picking up, the staff must

confirm that the person is listed on the release on the child's record or where the individual is not listed, ask the parent/guardian to provide authorization for pick-up in writing (e.g., note or email)

- document the change in pick-up procedure in the room communication log book
- sign the child in on the classroom attendance record

Where a full-day child has not arrived in care as expected (Sweet Pea, Toddler, Hunny Bear, Sesame and Dino Rooms)

Where a child does not arrive at Children's Circle Daycare as expected and the parent/guardian has not communicated a change in drop-off (e.g., left a voice message, sent an email or advised the closing staff at pick-up), the staff in the classroom must inform the office staff and they must commence contacting the child's parent/guardian no later than 10:30am when a child is typically dropped off in the morning, or by 2:30pm when the child is typically dropped off after 12pm. Staff shall call and email the parents/guardians, and if no response is received within an hour, the child will be deemed to be absent from care for the day.

Once the child's absence has been confirmed, program staff shall document the child's absence on the attendance record and any additional information about the child's absence in the room communication log book.

Where a kindergarten or school-age child has not arrived in care as expected (Cool Cat, Hot Shot and Room Above Rooms)

Upon admittance to Children's Circle, and annually thereafter, parents will complete a Permission to Escort form for their child(ren), authorizing Children's Circle staff to escort their child(ren) between a TDSB school and the centre. The parent will indicate on the form if the child is going to be dropped off at the centre in the morning. If a child in the Cool Cat, Hot Shot or Room Above rooms does not arrive by 8:20am in the morning on all TDSB instructional days, and it was indicated on the Permission to Escort form that they were coming in the morning, the staff will ensure no phone call or email was received indicating an absence, and will proceed to call the parent(s) to inquire about the child's whereabouts.

Parents are required to email or call the daycare office by 2:30pm, if we are not picking up their child from school.

If a child in the Cool Cat, Hot Shot or Room Above rooms is not in the designated location for pick up after school on all TDSB instructional days, and is not marked absent on the school pick up list, the staff will ask the TDSB school personnel (teacher and or office) about the child's whereabouts. If the TDSB school personnel indicates that the child was released as usual, the staff will call the daycare office to inform them and double-check that no message was received after the staff left for the pick up. The daycare office or staff will call and or email the parent/guardian to inquire about the child's whereabouts.

On all TDSB non-instructional days (P.A. Days, Winter Break, March Break, summer), the procedure for full-day children will apply.

Once the child's absence has been confirmed, program staff shall document the child's absence on the attendance record and any additional information about the child's absence in the room communication

log book.

Releasing a child from care

The staff who is supervising the child at the time of pick-up shall only release the child to the child's parent/guardian or individual that the parent/guardian has provided written or verbal authorization that Children's Circle Daycare may release the child to. Where the staff does not know the individual picking up the child (i.e., parent/guardian or authorized individual),

- confirm with another staff member that the individual picking up is the child's parent/guardian/authorized individual.
- where the above is not possible, ask the parent/guardian/authorized individual for photo identification and confirm the individual's information against the parent/guardian/authorized individual's name on the child's record or written authorization.

Where a child has not been picked up as expected (before centre closes)

Where a parent/guardian has previously communicated with the staff a specific time or timeframe that their child is to be picked up from care and the child has not been picked up within one hour of this time, the office or program staff shall contact the parent/guardian by phone and leave a message or email and advise that the child is still in care and has not been picked up.

- Where the individual picking up the child is an authorized individual and their contact information is available, the office or program staff shall proceed with contacting the individual to confirm pick-up as per the parent/guardian's instructions or leave a voice message to contact Children's Circle Daycare.
- Where the staff has not heard back from the parent/guardian or authorized individual who was to pick up the child the staff shall wait until the centre is closed and follow procedures for where a child has not been picked up and the centre is closed.

Where a child has not been picked up and the centre is closed

Where a parent/guardian or authorized individual who was supposed to pick up a child from Children's Circle Daycare and has not arrived by 6pm, the designated late staff shall ensure that the child is given a snack and activity, while they await their pick-up.

One staff shall stay with the child, while a second staff proceeds with calling the parent/guardian to advise that the child is still in care and inquire about their pick-up time. In the case where the person picking up the child is an authorized individual, the staff shall contact the parent/guardian first and then proceed to contact the authorized individual responsible for pick-up if unable to reach the parent/guardian.

If the staff is unable to reach the parent/guardian or authorized individual who was responsible for picking up the child by 6:30pm, the staff shall start calling the emergency contacts on the child's record.

Where the staff is unable to reach the parent/guardian or any other authorized individual listed on the

child's file (e.g., the emergency contacts) by 7pm, the staff shall proceed with contacting the local Children's Aid Society (CAS). Staff shall follow the CAS worker's direction with respect to next steps (name and contact information of CAS worker is to be documented in the office communication log book).

Monitoring & Review

Children's Circle will monitor this policy and update it whenever necessary. The policy along with other relevant policies will be reviewed with all employees, placement students, clients, and volunteers on an annual basis. If an employee has any concerns with this policy, they should be brought to the attention of the Executive Director or the Board of Directors.